



We're off to see the lizard

By JANICE ALLEN
Post Reporter

If you are seeking ways to amuse your offspring during the summer, you might consider stopping by the Museum of Natural Science to watch the reconstruction — of a monster.

The *Dipliodocus* being reassembled there is a dinosaur that measures 80 feet from nose to tip of tail. He weighed about 30 tons when he roamed the earth about 150 million years ago. His skeleton is so long that its tail must be curved around to make it fit in the display space.

"This is the first major dinosaur to be constructed in the United States since the 1890's," John Barber, one of the men responsible for the reconstruction, said.

Barber, guided by Dr. Wann Langston, a paleontologist on the University of Texas faculty, and Dr. Langston have been mounting the specimen for more than two and a half years.

According to Barber, it is one to be proud of. About 60 per cent of the actual bone structure of the animal has been preserved. The fossils were found near the Powder River in Wyoming in 1890.

"Both of the specimen's 100-pound shoulder blades are still intact and the right front foot of the animal is the only actual *Dipliodocus* foot in existence," Barber said.

The rest of the specimen will be carefully constructed from plaster and other materials. "It is no easy task to put together a dinosaur. All of the work is done by hand, including the placement of the heavy limbs

Below, Langston, right, and Barber adjust rib of dinosaur which is being built in museum, above. —Post photos by Jerry Clark



of the animals, Barber said.

"Right now we are in the process of constructing the animal's 20 ribs, which were not found intact," Barber said.

A new technique had to be developed to construct the ribs, he said.

"A plaster set of ribs would probably have weighed about 750 pounds," Barber said. "This weight would have been too heavy for the frame, so we had to make a plaster mold, and make the ribs out of plaster which reduced the weight to about 40 pounds."

Each set, which consists of one rib on each side of the animal, takes a full week to construct. The longest rib is about 6 feet long.

Dr. Langston and Barber have taken such pains to see that the specimen is historically correct, that the same amount of pressure is being applied on each foot that would be applied if the animal were actually walking.

Barber said it is almost impossible to determine the cost of the exhibit.

"Although there is a lot of money involved in the construction of an exhibit this size, it is really the cheapest exhibit in the museum," Barber said.

"It is probably the largest exhibit in the museum and has been constructed to stand more than 100 years."

Barber said the reconstruction should be finished by October.

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News/features B

Names in the news

Ehrlichman, family cited

Former White House aide John D. Ehrlichman, convicted in the Watergate cover-up case, is "apparently out of touch" with his family, columnist Maxine Cleveland reported Saturday. Writing in Sunday's Washington Post, Cleveland said Ehrlichman is now living in Santa Fe, N.M., and his wife Jeanne is in Bellevue, Wash., their home town.

Jordan queen to give birth

Jordan's Queen Alia will give birth to her second child toward the end of the year, a Royal Palace announcement said Saturday in Amman. The announcement said the birth was expected during the second half of December. The Queen has a one-year-old daughter, Ranya, by King Hussein whom she married three years ago. Hussein also has five other children — three daughters and two sons — by previous marriages.

Princess marries

Princess Christina married Jorge Gullerms, a Cuban-American who runs a day-care center in a New York ghetto, on Saturday and gave up her rights to the Dutch throne. Thousanda cheered and brass bands played as the couple, both 25, entered the town hall at Baarn, 20 miles southeast of Amsterdam near Soerabij Palace, for the initial 20-minute civil ceremony.

Ransom gets UT honor

Chancellor emeritus Dr. Harry Ransom and five others have been selected as distinguished alumni of the University of Texas. They will be honored in Austin Oct. 24. The other honorees are Liz Carpenter, former press secretary to Mrs. Lyndon Johnson and now vice president of Hill & Knowlton, Inc., public relations firm; Maurice Granville, chairman of the board of directors of Tracair, Inc.; Rex Love, chairman of the board of Texas Commerce Bancshares.

Man's burial wish granted

George William Holyfield had his final wish carried out. He has been buried with his motorcycle, Holyfield, 23, told his family and friends in Richmond, Va., recently that if anything ever happened to him he wanted to be buried with his customized Harley Davidson "chopper." He was electrocuted Tuesday when he apparently touched some bare wires while working on a utility pole in the city, police said.

Russian meets with Pope

Soviet Foreign Minister Andrei Gromyko had a one-hour audience Saturday with Pope Paul VI, and the Vatican said the discussions centered on the status of the 125 million Roman Catholics in the Soviet Union. It was Gromyko's fifth meeting with the 77-year-old pontiff since 1963. With the Vatican's foreign minister, Agostino Cardinal Casaroli, sitting in, they also discussed peace and disarmament, the Middle East and the European Security Conference, the Vatican spokesman said.

Princess advances in trials

England's Princess Anne advanced in the U.S. Open Championship Horse Trials Saturday, but her husband Capt. Mark Phillips was eliminated. The princess turned in what a judge called an "absolutely superb" performance to advance to eighth place in a 35-rider field. Phillips was eliminated when his horse, Laureate II, refused a jump. Beth Perkins, 15, took

3 to address young GOP

Bond to tell of entry

Georgia State Sen. Julian Bond told graduating students at Antioch College in Yellow Springs, Ohio, on Saturday that he intends to formally announce his candidacy for President within two weeks. "I hope I can represent the splinter groups," Bond said during a news conference before the commencement ceremony. "I hope they don't go off in all directions."

Greek city planner dies

Constantinos Ixiadis, an internationally acclaimed city planner who designed communities in more than 10 countries, died Saturday after a long illness. He was 62. Among projects Ixiadis planned were sections of Islamabad, Pakistan, and Eastwick, Pa. He had served as minister and advisor in most of the Greek governments since World War II and had received honorary degrees from several American universities.

Button at rectory again

"Blonde bombshell" Betty Button, former star of screen and stage who became a cook in a church rectory while trying to rebuild her troubled life, is back for a rest from worldly pressures. "She is fine, very, very good, but not quite ready to get into the real pressures of entertainment and the business world," Rev. Peter Maguire, pastor of St. Anthony's Church in Portsmouth, R.I., said.

Rabbi to be admiral

Rabbi Bertram W. Korn, a Naval Reservist, will become a rear admiral next week. The Navy said he will be the first rabbi to reach flag rank. Korn will serve as senior reserve chaplain.



Lynn Ashby is on vacation. His column will resume July 15

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